

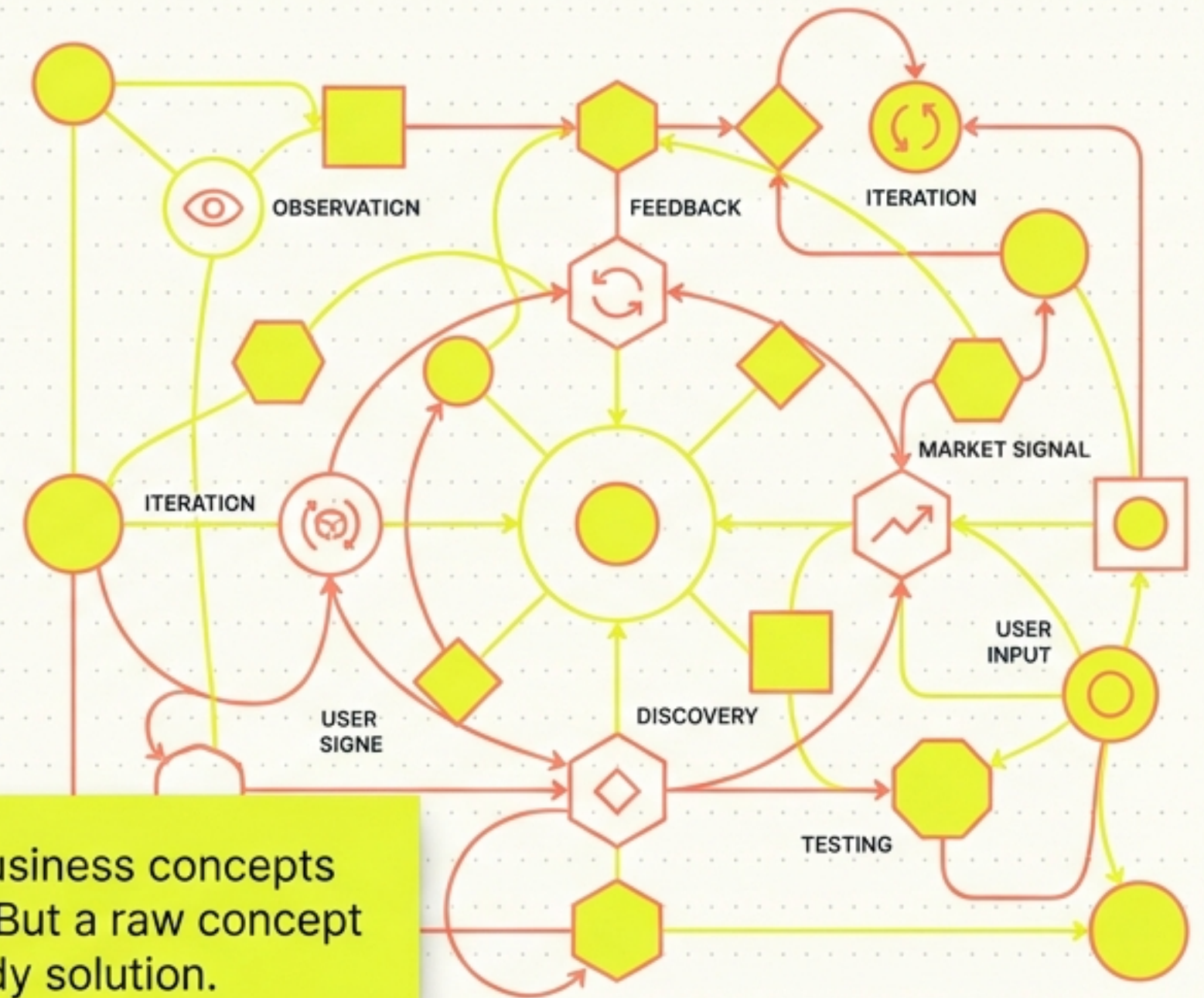


The Search for Great Ideas

Harnessing creativity to empower innovation.

A conceptual breakdown of the Michigan State University framework for generating, testing, and validating business opportunities.

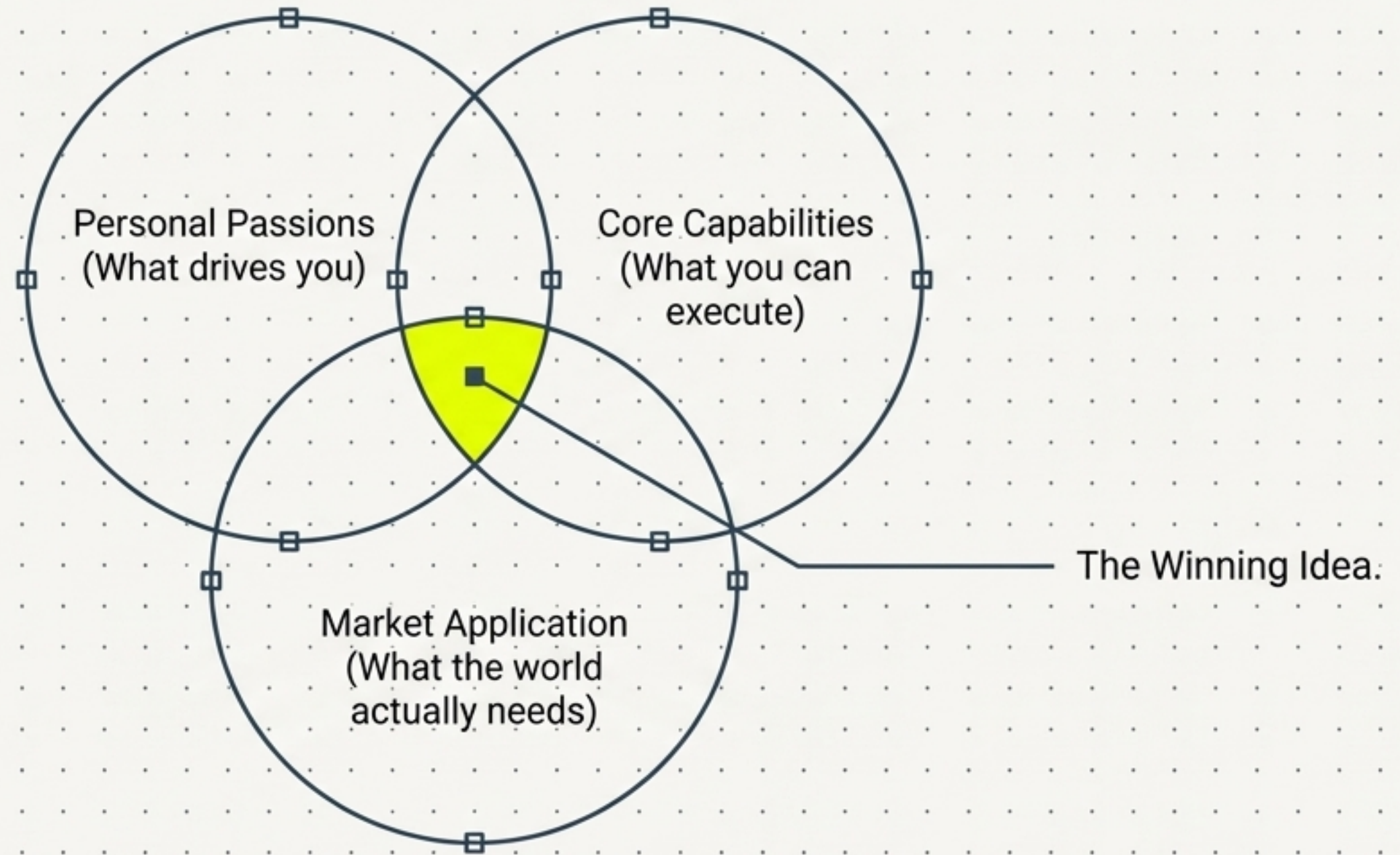
Where do great business ideas actually come from?



We all have compelling business concepts we've pondered for years. But a raw concept is not a market-ready solution.

Great ideas aren't just found in a stroke of genius; they are engineered through deliberate observation, structured testing, and external discovery.

The Anatomy of a Viable Opportunity

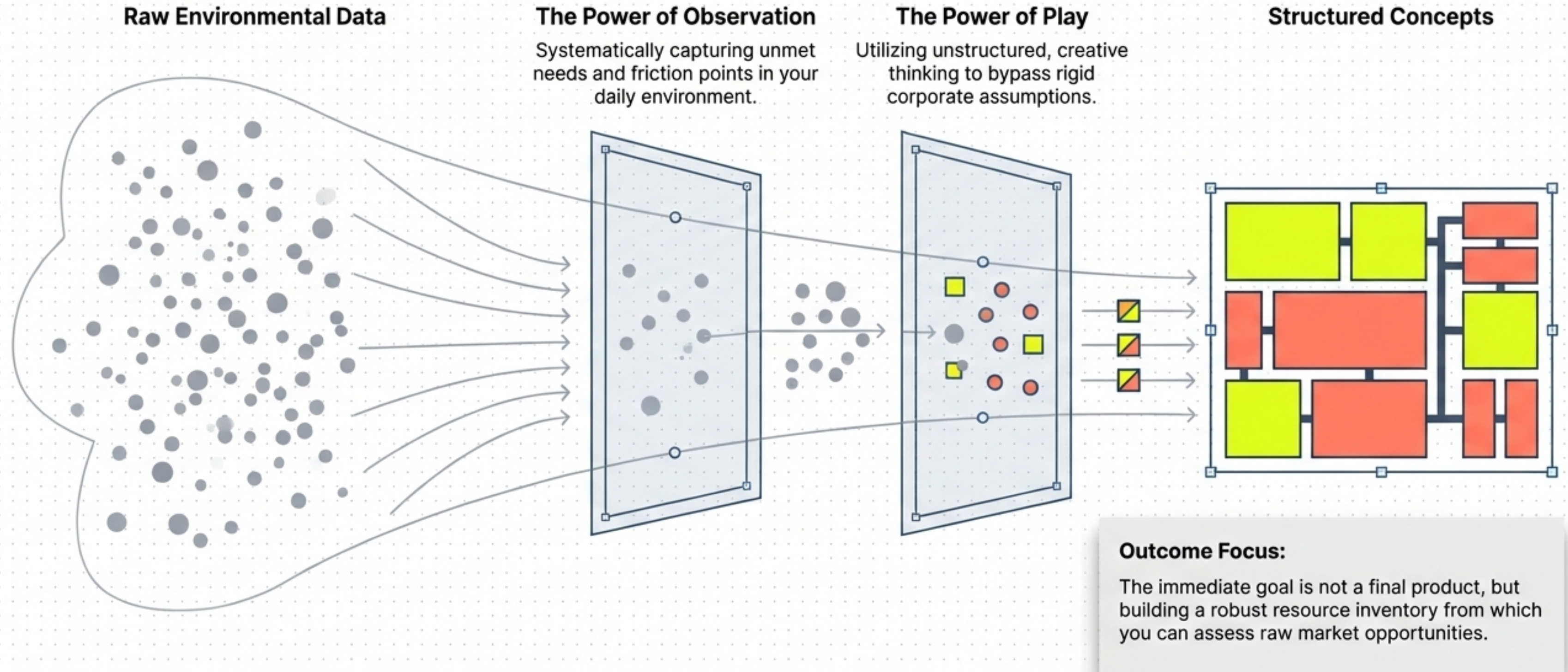


The goal of this framework is to aggressively triage potential ideas until you land precisely in this intersection.

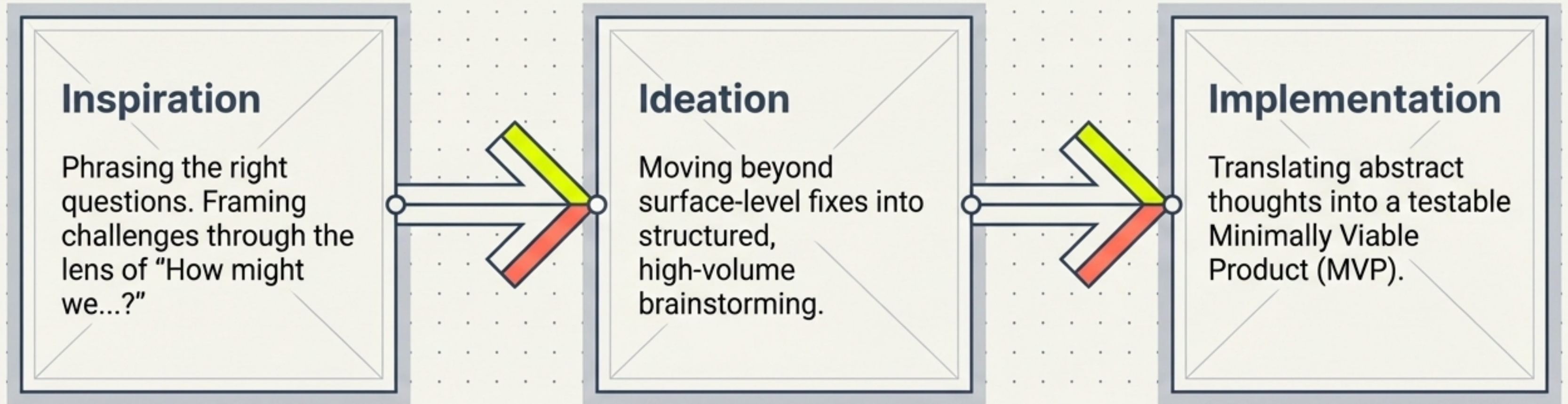
A Three-Phase Blueprint for Innovation



Phase 1: Changing How You See the World



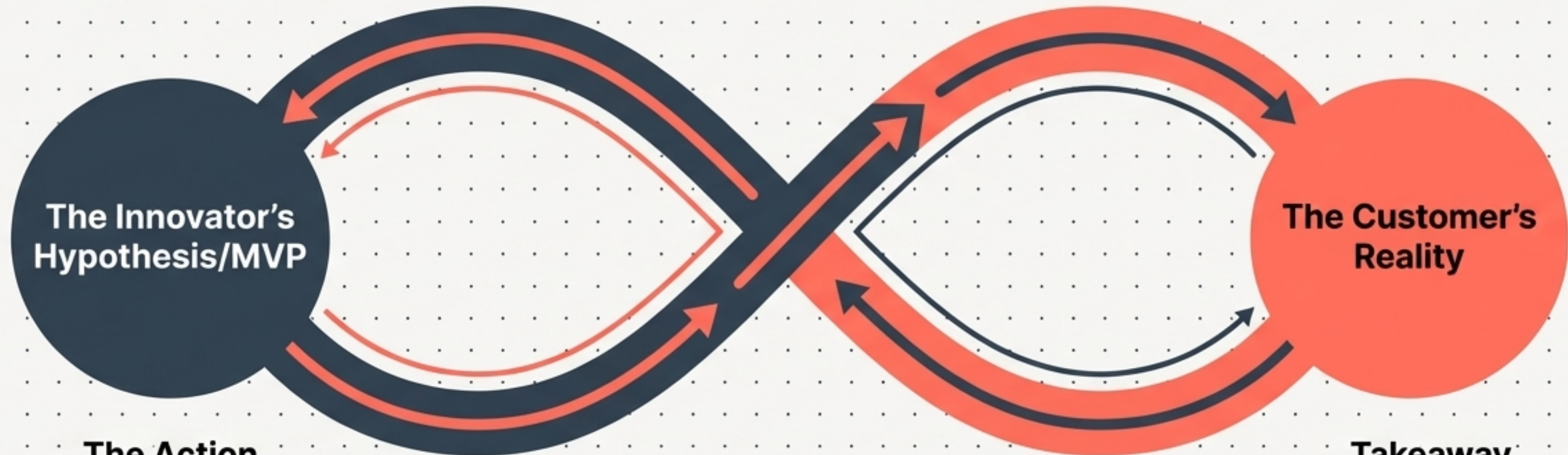
Phase 2: Structuring the Chaos



Design thinking is the mechanism that turns abstract creativity into a tangible business asset.

Phase 3: Leaving the Building

“More often than not, the best solutions don’t lie with you—they lie with your customers.”



The Action

Developing a rigorous Customer Discovery Plan to aggressively test the MVP against real-world friction.

Takeaway

Innovation happens in the dialogue, not in isolation.

Upgrading Your Innovation Operating System

The Old Way

Source of Idea

Internal guesswork, waiting for inspiration, isolated brainstorming.

Product Development

Building the perfect, finalized product in secret.

Market Validation

Launching and hoping a market exists.

The MSU Framework

External observation, active environmental scanning, customer dialogue.

Rapid, low-fidelity MVP iteration and testing.

Data-driven customer discovery and hypothesis validation prior to scaling.

The Innovator's Toolkit (Competencies Acquired)



Creative Engine

- Creative Thinking
- Ideation Methodologies
- Unstructured Creativity



Strategic Execution

- Design Thinking
- Product Development
- Resource Planning
- Decision Making



Market Intelligence

- User Research
- Evaluating Market Opportunities
- Gathering Customer Insights

Backed by Rigor, Built for Flexibility

4.6/5 Stars

(316 reviews)

95%

Learner Approval

23,976

Enrolled

3 Core Modules

~10 hours total
time commitment

100%
Flexible schedule

Led by Michigan State University instructors Ken Szymusiak, Forrest S. Carter, and David Wheeler.

Really is a course that gets you thinking... pushing you to get more creative and think outside the box. - A.S.

Ready to find your next great idea?

Stop waiting for inspiration to strike. Learn the framework to engineer it.

 **Enroll in 'The Search for Great Ideas' via Coursera.**